ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; Step Up to the Challenge** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** dreams are earned through sustained commitment and help from others	Central.
2	**(b)** safety may cost us growth	Interpretation.
3	**(b)** Having counted the cost, Ming began her journey.	Perfect participle.
4	**(a)** it assumes the dreamer has access to support and resources	Critique.
5	**(c)** a belief that courage is a choice	Ethos.
6	**(b)** Mother said that had she known my plan, she would have helped.	Unreal past retained.
7	**(b)** honest care	Honesty.
8	**(b)** Avoid all challenges	Contradicts.
9	**(d)** persistence	Persistence.
10	**(c)** dreams must be 'paid for' with effort	Metaphor.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It includes cost, sacrifice and change (1) so it tempers idealism with reality (1).	1+1
12	Clear structure and tone (1) with honest, kind content (1).	1+1
13	Plain words reflect decisive action (1) and avoid excuses (1).	1+1
14	She does not deny it (1) but frames effort and learning as valuable anyway (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Sacrifice shows commitment (1). Not all success needs the same sacrifice (1). The letter stresses it as a typical cost (1).	1+1+1
16	Simplicity reaches all (1). It matches direct action (1). It avoids obscuring the message (1).	1+1+1
17	Barely had she started when problems arose (1). Inversion after barely (1). It adds emphasis (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It acknowledges cost (1). It accepts change (1). It stresses support (1).	1+1+1
18	Comfort as a room or trap (1). The challenge as a climb or door (1). Metaphors show the cost of staying (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It means to work late into the night (1). Dreams may need such effort (1). It illustrates sacrifice (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hope begins the dream (1). Effort fulfils it (1). Sacrifice is the price (1). Support is the safety net (1). Flexibility keeps the contract fair (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Letter: explanation and advice (1). Poem: image and rhythm (1). Letter is personal (1). Poem is universal (1). Both aim at action (1).	2+2+1
20	Warmth (1). Honesty (1). Practical advice (1). Respect for Ming's choice (1). Effect on the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Letter's lessons (1). Poem's lessons (1). Practical steps (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; Step Up to the Challenge** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** failure gives experience that builds success	Learning.
2	**(b)** ambition	Ambition.
3	**(a)** she is excited but uncertain	Inference.
4	**(d)** limits growth though it feels safe	Distinction.
5	**(d)** Who would not want to follow a dream?	Rhetorical.
6	**(b)** encourages bold dreaming while insisting on realism	Balanced.
7	**(a)** security vs aspiration	Tension.
8	**(b)** a persistent learner who masters a skill by practice	Counterexample.
9	**(a)** to be free to follow a dream, one must bind oneself to discipline	Paradox.
10	**(b)** repetition of a call such as 'Take the step!'	Persuasion.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Passion starts the journey (1) and discipline sustains it (1).	1+1
12	The letter speaks to one person with wider relevance (1). The poem speaks to everyone directly (1).	1+1
13	Love gives credibility and warmth (1) while personal stakes make it sincere (1).	1+1
14	'Step up' commands action (1) and implies we are capable (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A letter is personal and sincere (1). It allows advice without pressure (1). It becomes a lasting guide (1).	1+1+1
16	It praises courage (1). It does not detail dangers (1). It leaves room for the reader's judgement (1).	1+1+1
17	For: practicality brings results (1). Against: bold dreams inspire (1). A mix works best, as the letter shows (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The advice applies to anyone (1). The mother-daughter bond adds warmth (1). It empowers a girl to dream (1).	1+1+1
18	If Ming had planned, she would not have struggled (1). Third conditional (1). Marks regret about the past (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Persistence keeps effort going (1). Flexibility adapts the aim (1). Together they prevent burnout (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Emotional greeting (1). Logical points on cost (1). Examples of support (1). Balanced caution (1). Hopeful end (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Encouragement (1). Cost and effort (1). Support (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Lack of action (1). Underestimating cost (1). Lack of support (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). The goal (1). The fear (1). The step (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; Step Up to the Challenge** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** dreams demand courage, effort, support and flexibility	Synthesis.
2	**(a)** evidence that effort rarely matters	Counter-evidence.
3	**(b)** valuing every goal	Inclusive view.
4	**(a)** courage and persistence	Common.
5	**(d)** growth over rigid plans	Adaptability.
6	**(b)** If Ming had planned better, she would have succeeded sooner.	Had + would have.
7	**(b)** an example of wishful thinking	Link.
8	**(d)** a dream should match one's passion and ability	Fit.
9	**(c)** Only by sustained effort can dreams come true.	Inversion after only.
10	**(d)** The First Step Is Yours	Title.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It stresses individual effort (1) but also notes the role of support systems (1).	1+1
12	Access to support and resources matters (1) so the letter's advice works best with help, which it acknowledges (1).	1+1
13	Fear is natural (1) but must not decide our actions (1).	1+1
14	Offer guidance and opportunities (1) and encourage persistence and flexibility (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Honesty builds trust (1). It prepares Ming for reality (1). It respects her ability to cope (1).	1+1+1
16	Ming was given valuable advice by her mother (1). Indirect object becomes subject (1). Verb: was given (1).	1+1+1
17	Letter: fear as a reason to plan (1). Poem: fear as a barrier to cross (1). Both urge acting despite fear (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She may underestimate effort (1). She may give up early (1). She may feel regret (1).	1+1+1
18	Having read the letter, Ming made a plan (1). Perfect participle shows earlier action (1). Same subject (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A plan needs steps (1). A deadline adds urgency (1). The letter supports planning and effort (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Theme (1). Imperative voice (1). Metaphor (1). Rhythm (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Meaning (1). The poem's first step (1). The letter's sacrifice (1). Examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Meaning (1). Examples (1). Why fear grows (1). How belief helps (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Choose a goal (1). Learn from craft (1). Value of words (1). Courage and effort (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.